

“IoT is a Great Fuel for Digital Transformation”

The Internet of Things (IoT) has become an important part of today's digital era. It provides tons and tons of data that needs to be managed and is a great fuel for digital transformation. **Sreenath C. Lakshmanan, founder and CEO, i4DigitalValue**, discusses the need for IoT in the post-pandemic era at the India Technology Week.

Q. You say IoT digital transformation is important in the post-pandemic era. Can you explain this by using an example?

A. Let me explain this question by taking an example of how IoT works. As we all know, IoT is all about data. The focus is always to make data-driven decisions that are critical for any IoT business value. We should not ignore this data, but we need to innovate with it.

Once structured, semi-structured, and unstructured data are collected from IoT devices and sensors, these are sent to cloud via gateways, which use cellular and satellite communications for transmission. IoT platforms analyse the three types of data, and then user alerts are sent after data visualisation. Advanced techniques like artificial intelligence (AI) help with intelligent data decisions.

Integrated design thinking and digital transformation principles provide complete clarity. First, in generating appropriate data, aggregating data, optimising data, consolidating relevant data, and finally analysing data for business decisions. Second, in finalising IoT devices and sensors, cloud platforms, and cellular and satellite communications, which cater to specific requirements of devised bankable innovation.

Also, it provides a direction to adopt AI to make intelligent data decisions that would improve IoT operations and improve human/machine communications. The solutions can be



Sreenath C. Lakshmanan,
founder and CEO, i4DigitalValue

built for smarter logistics, production, supply-chain, city, buildings, and more.

Q. Can you explain why IoT digital transformation is critical in the post-pandemic era for the Indian market?

A. From various reports, it is expected that the worldwide spending on IoT would surpass the one trillion dollar mark in 2022. In India, IoT end-user solutions are expected to be around five to six per cent of worldwide spending.

The big question is whether all these companies can survive and be successful in this highly competitive market, which is already facing the heat of the pandemic.

The market in India needs products and services customised for its specific

needs, and the solutions must cater to these needs. A company that develops a bankable innovation, providing significant commercial value with problem-solving, scalable, and cost-efficient solutions, can disrupt the IoT market. This will result in a rapid change in market and business needs.

In my opinion, IoT digital transformation avoids disruptions and helps cater to the IoT market and business needs for enterprises to stay ahead in the competition.

In India, many organisations are trying to build a high level of digital literacy. But the older generation of customers may struggle in using these new technologies. This problem needs to be addressed by offering simplified, highly-productive IoT solutions.

Q. Can you tell us how startups can build a bankable solution to be an IoT successful company using digital transformation?

A. The startups should have a digital mindset of ‘Can we do differently?’ If this culture starts in the beginning, the transformation success is very high. One of the approaches that startups can use is ‘design thinking integrated with customer experience.’

The principle of design thinking provides excellent clarity to unpack problems and successfully navigate for desirable solutions with the human-centered design process and out of the box thinking. Customer experience principles, on the other hand, provide

